Probiotics/digestive aids: HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

Pendergrass, K. (2026). Probiotics/digestive aids: HMTc Standard. Institute of Contaminant Standards.

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified heavy-metal-safety standard for probiotics/digestive aids in Pet Supplements, evaluated on the supplement as sold (as-packaged concentrate): dry weight for powders, chews, tablets and capsules, neat liquid for oils and drops; no reconstitution, dilution, or as-fed conversion is applied. 7 of 11 panel analytes publish a numeric limit taken from the strictest applicable government maximum; the remainder are held under mandatory control or a substantiated not-material determination.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default), pet-supplement double over-compliance form: the exact cell's only sovereign maximum is an animal-feed instrument, which is disclosed as a floor and never used; every published value is a disclosed read-across to the strictest applicable as-sold child-protective human-food sovereign maximum in the product's native as-sold basis, or a control where no as-sold sovereign value exists. Never occurrence-derived.

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	10	human-grade read-across (Israel)
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	5	human-grade read-across (Israel)

Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	50	human-grade read-across (India)
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	20	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	4	human-grade read-across (Israel)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	250	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	5,000	human-grade read-across (India)
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	500	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,000	human-grade read-across (China)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	≤ Cr	bounded by Cr (reflex speciation)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	10	Israel — human-food analog
Cadmium (Cd)	5	Israel — human-food analog
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	India — human-food analog
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	20	European Union — human-food analog
Mercury, total (tHg)	4	Israel — human-food analog
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.

Nickel (Ni)	250	European Union — human-food analog
Tin (Sn)	5,000	India — human-food analog
Aluminium (Al)	500	Australia / New Zealand — human-food analog
Total chromium (Cr)	1,000	China — human-food analog
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	≤ Cr	Cr-VI carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total Cr (Cr-VI <= Cr), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Probiotics/digestive aids: HMTc standard*. Institute of Contaminant Standards.

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References

[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds iAs, Ni. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] Israel — human-food maximum levels
Binds Pb, Cd, tHg. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[5] India — human-food maximum levels
Binds tAs, Sn. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/pet-supplements-probiotics-digestive. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/pet-supplements-probiotics-digestive.

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